

Chapter 25-10

When it was past eight o'clock, Liang Shi got up to prepare to leave.

She had just stepped out the door and hadn't yet gotten in the car when Qiu Zimin called out to her, "Shi, wait."

Liang Shi turned around, her brow slightly furrowed, her tone cold: "What is it?"

She didn't think she and Qiu Zimin had anything left to discuss.

"You've read the text messages Mom sent you, right?" Qiu Zimin asked her, but there was some probing in her words, "Why didn't you reply to Mom? Haven't you forgiven Mom yet?"

The wind was picking up outside. Liang Shi gathered her white suit jacket and tucked her scattered hair behind her ear, "What do you want to say?"

"Nothing." Qiu Zimin's tone was heavy, "Mom didn't do it on purpose either. The family is carrying such a heavy burden, your father's white hair has increased, and the southern plot of land is crucial for our family. Whether we can restore our former glory depends on this opportunity. Yi'an truly likes you, and didn't you also want to divorce that one from the Xu family..."

"When did I say I wanted a divorce?" Liang Shi interrupted her words, "When I married Xu Qingzhu, I made it clear that you only needed to handle that one time, and you don't need to manage anything afterward."

Having recovered some memories, Liang Shi spoke with more confidence.

"Then you and Yi'an..." Qiu Zimin paused.

Liang Shi answered firmly, "Not possible."

"But Liang Shi, have you forgotten who fed you, clothed you, and raised you all these years?" Qiu Zimin's expression immediately changed. In her eyes, there was no trace of guilt, and the previous submissiveness seemed like Liang Shi's illusion.

"Even if it was you, you don't have the right to interfere with my marriage at will." Liang Shi said: "Making me undergo surgery to be with Zhou Yi'an - you really came up with that idea."

Qiu Zimin snorted coldly, "Many people are doing this now. How am I harming you? In the future, with the Zhou family as support, it won't be a waste of all these years raising you. Besides, you could live better than you do now."

"This issue is not necessary for us to discuss." Liang Shi said, "I won't do this, and you'd better stay away from Zhou Yi'an too. That person is very dangerous."

Actually, very evil.

Because you never knew what a psychologically twisted person would do.

"I've eaten more salt than you've eaten rice¹, and I'm better at judging people than you. That Xu Qingzhu is not a peaceful person and will definitely harm you greatly in the future." Qiu Zimin said: "What's wrong with Zhou Yi'an?"

"You just have your eye on the Zhou family." Liang Shi exposed her lie.

Liang Shi stared straight at her and suddenly asked in a low voice: "Are you still my mother?"

Qiu Zimin's eyes flickered, then she said firmly: "You came from my belly, how could I not be your mother? Liang Shi, I'm thinking of you. If you don't want to listen, then forget it. Even though the Liang family has accommodated you in everything all these years, I've indulged and spoiled you, and everyone says my daughter is no good and worthless, but I never believed it. I knew my daughter was good, my daughter was obedient, it's just that they couldn't see it. Now thinking about it, I should have been wrong."

"No matter what, it's your choice. Mom is just making a suggestion. If you don't like it, I won't say it anymore." Qiu Zimin said: "The Liang family's decline is inevitable. Who told me I didn't raise good children? In the future when I die, I won't be able to face the Liang family ancestors."

Liang Shi: "..."

These lines were so familiar.

Liang Shi had once acted in a drama about PUA².

The male character paid money to take classes specifically to PUA wealthy girls, undermining their confidence, making them unable to leave him, spending money on him, finding jobs for him, and having to appease him submissively.

Qiu Zimin's current rhetoric was identical to PUA tactics.

First came the put-down, saying you're really terrible, your existence is harm to this world, then she would say, but I believe in you, I'm the only one in this world who treats you well, so you can trust me, everything I ask you to do is for your own good.

Over time, the other person would become a puppet that could be manipulated at will.

In more serious cases, they might become depressed or mentally unstable.

Liang Shi just looked at Qiu Zimin coldly. After she finished speaking, she lightly asked back: "Anything else?"

"Mom transferred money to you." Qiu Zimin said, "You don't have a job either, and the house you live in was bought by us. Although you don't want to compromise, I am your mother after all, and I can't not care about you. Take this money and spend it. It's cold, drive slowly when you go back."

Liang Shi: "Oh."

She got in the car, then rolled down the window and said to Qiu Zimin: "I'll be working at Dongheng from now on, so you don't need to give me living expenses. Also, Chuanlan Villa belongs to you, I'm just temporarily living there. When I have money, I'll move out."

Qiu Zimin's expression twisted for a moment, but she forced a smile: "What are you saying? Can I not care about my own daughter? You're still young and don't have much earning ability..."

"I'm already married." Liang Shi said: "I will take on the corresponding responsibilities."

She looked at Qiu Zimin, "So, don't think about controlling me anymore."

The car drove out of the old residence villa.

Qiu Zimin stood at the door, her hands clutching her coat, her eyes containing towering fury.

After a long while, Qiu Zimin gritted her teeth and spat out two words: "Waste."

Footnotes:

¹ "I've eaten more salt than you've eaten rice" (我吃過的鹽比你吃過的飯都多) - A Chinese idiom meaning "I have more life experience than you."

² PUA - "Pick-up Artist," referring to manipulative tactics used to control and exploit others emotionally, often in romantic contexts.